



THE ICONOCLAST

VOL 2, SUMMER 1

This issue is dedicated to Mister Allen Ginsberg, rebel poet, who died this month of liver cancer.

It should be noted that not everyone has the deep profound respect for mister ginsberg that the beat followers wished he deserved. Seeing a picture of the man in a dedication, an Iconoclast member compared him to the Frugal Gourmet. Another commented "i liked him better when he was alive." The most boisterous claims i received about his lascivious leech-like behaviour came from Archer Anon. He is quoted as saying:

"He's a fucking freak corporate beatnik coming from the Ivy League who cashed in on others' miseries....He wrote half-asked poetry to be digested by the masses like corn flakes....Oh, and he hit on his interns." But, so he did a lot of pot and slept with lots of people--he still wrote some ok poetry, and we're sad he's dead. Death is kind of permanent, and i had hoped that i would get the opportunity to tell him he stunk really bad. Pee you!

Of Life (An essay written in the style of Francis Bacon) by Anthony Simeone

Oh life, Oh life, wailed fragile humanity, why hast thou forsaken us? Neglect Malice, noble Dante, for this blasphemy be the one God doth abominate most. Methinks, if this mortal were He, I would sooner consign breath to *excretia*; perhaps such a heavenly endowment might then be duly appreciated. 'Tis a grim revelation that the preponderance of mankind hath relinquished all hope of jubilant life. If ever there was a divine purpose bestowed upon my own self, 'twould be to right this malady.

So what is life? A beating heart? A reasoning mind? Such was enough for Descartes, who did proclaim *Cogito, ergo sum*. I think, therefore I am. Mayhap it is a feeling soul? Or a menagerie of happenings suspended upon a tapestry of years? I say unto thee that it is all of these, yet more. Were these not the words of blessed *Seneca: Vita nec bonum nec malum est; boni ac mali locus est*. Life is neither a good nor an evil; it is the place

where good and evil exist. And he was but one of those virtuous sages that, since time immemorial, have endeavored to guide humanity with his own transient wisdom, lest it perish with him.

And though 'tis magnanimous to define life, to counsel others in the proper methods of nurturing said gift 'twould be doubly noble. Firstly, youth is not wasted upon the young but forsaken by the old. To maintain that freshness is to ensure happiness. Be not maudlin, but seek out joy; 'tis the only way one may find it, 'twill not come to thee of its own accord. Be ye wary of those who sow apathy. And yet do not scorn them, for some may be the victims of fate, and suffer from an imbalance of the humors in favor of melancholy. In thy convictions be as unshakable as the ancient oak. Surrender not the mind to the whims of others. Strive to succeed, and thereby immortalize thy name for eternity.

Opportunity by sean mulroy

Jake was the awkward, timid sort. He dreaded returning to his school every day. That is, until the day he laid eyes on the "new girl." With one glimpse of Sarah, Jake realized what his late parents meant when they spoke of "love." For his entire life, Jake had been so welcome datacompunassertive that it was as if he was a wraith. Jake was afraid to ask someone for the time, much less unconditional love. For once, though, Jake decided to garner up his pride and act. He moved toward his new obsession with a determined optimism. But, as doubting second thoughts oozed into Jake's mind, he halted and changed course. "She'd never spit on me, much less speak to me," Jake softly whispered to himself. The sad truth was that Jake was right. They were never meant to be together. Jake would steal loving gazes at Sarah all the time, but Sarah never noticed. Frustration seemed a perfect companion for Jake, and it probably would have been forever if it had not been for Dennis.

Dennis was Sarah's other, less conscientious admirer. Dennis possessed the traits of every brain dead, muscle-head asshole you would ever want to meet. He wanted Sarah, too. But not in

the tender way that Jake did. Dennis did not know love. He got his thrill from the musty smell of pain and the sweet taste of blood. Dennis was particularly hungry the day he saw Sarah traveling home alone. The delicate princess had no clue as the cold indifferent Dennis slithered behind her waiting to strike. Dennis made a fierce lunge toward his altar, and Sarah was yanked down with amazing force. A soothing voice said to her "Not a word." Sarah was shocked to open her eyes and see Jake, the heroic stranger who had stashed her away in his secret nook. A nook that Dennis could never find, much less fit in. The big bastard could be heard outside, occasionally screaming the prophetic "shit" and "goddamn bitch."

Jake stole Sarah's heart in that place with the beautiful words that seemed to flow so freely from his lips. They would never spend another moment apart for the rest of their short futile lives. They died together at the end of a perfect, sun-baked afternoon, having fallen prey to an invisible foe more wicked than Dennis. I had both Jake and Sarah for lunch today, and they were delicious. Don't worry, they were dolphin-free.

Hickory by Gregory Pardlo

The coincidental audience -
would be passersby
stood in morbid curiosity
and I stood back as if I had snuck
into a theater struck
dumb by the insolent metaphor;
that insistent butt refusing
to be extinguished on winter's
cool tongue of earth catching also
Pillows of snow
like paratroopers,
landing, prescient and proximate,
with the copulent thud
of a tossed rose,
while the woven din
of sirens enshrouds me
like bereavement.

As with a pious gesture,
the structure begins to kneel
and embers litter the air
as if they deserve to be there
forever.
And I imagine being swept up inside
the swarming constellation
like a marionette
at the close of a scene
sifting through all of them;
those glinting wind chimes wincing
at the sigh of my tangled motion
and I
disregard their warnings
like a headstrong pyrotechnist's
apprentice
and the flare of my trajectory
might then become silent
as if I had just flit
in a fit
of mummery
beyond the horizon.

While the crowd shudders in
the shallow of a breath,
in that pregnant vacuum,

backstage (behind
this yellow tape) I might
nimblely fill my lungs
with acrid dense sky,
pluck my cigarette along
a dramatic arc,
and proceed to climb
the steps naked
into that burning house
to be received awash
in limelight and waves
of ovation.

for christopher

by andrea chrismán

a host of silences is hung about my neck;
in vague shifts of light
atrocities make themselves known
in 925 ways of sound.

sometimes softness grips my throat
and kindly suffocates
then reaching hands extending down my
larynx
constricting airflow;
blood quickens,
blue skin...

other times
the silver eyelets rip gently at seams
pulling my trachea from its house
opening air passages
pulling apart vocal chords
leaving no voice or sound
just tunnels of air
and weeping from bronchial tubes;
peaceful pink skin on lips
from over-oxygenation
heavy heaving of unconsciousness.

the silvers around my neck sit-
vacant reminders-
hung like broken vials
in july's mortuary.

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<>!*"#
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(translation)

Waka waka bang splat tick tick hash
Caret quote back-tick dollar dollar dash,
Bang splat equal at dollar under-score,
Percent splat waka waka tilde number four
Amperсанд bracket bracket dot dot slash
Vertical-bar curly-bracket comma comma
CRASH !

Samsara of intimacy¹

by jonathan fasczyk

cyclical, delusional grandeur of emotion
endless

The birth comes with impulse
Action of single resolve
Free and ignorant

Growth we hope
should breathe and age
like fine wine

But then comes
the plague
disabling and raw

And death of our
old friend
the ultimate measure of time
leaves us bare once again
Nude in the face of
the spinning human wheel

Keats I pray to you
to travel back in time
and omit your Ode on Melancholy

¹ The repeating cycle of pain: of birth,
suffering, old age, disease and death.

Sylvia: A Journal of Literature and Art will be producing its Winter / Spring 1997 issue in April. Copies are \$5. Sylvia will be available in Borders, Barnes and Noble, and the Rutgers-Camden bookstore. Or send a check to the address below with your name and address. Sylvia is also soliciting creative manuscripts for its Summer / Fall issue. Deadline is September 1. Send four pieces (max) to P.O. Box 654, Maple Shade, NJ 08052, or email your submission to bassam1@clam.rutgers.edu.

THE ICONOCLAST (<http://clam.rutgers.edu/~p00h/iconoclast/index.html>) is brought to you by Andrea Chrisman, Anthony Simeone, Bruce Kramer, Amy Popp, & Jonathan Fasczyk. Layout by Matthew W. Weatherbee. Illustrations by Steve Wolff. Writers o'rama: Jen Oliver, John Rothwell, Greg Pardlo, Bertram Redgrave, Nicole Nader, Tom Wright Jr., Susan Muaddi, Julie Kozempel, and Amy Sciarretto, Khary McGhee, . Muses to the Writers: Shawn Sullivan, Valencia Jackson, Slappy Stink Fairy, and Harvey Hurricane. *Please send all submissions, donations, Gophered Scuppernon to p00h@clam.rutgers.edu (the two Os are zeroes), or The Iconoclast, c/o P.O. Box 2133, Cinnaminson, NJ 0807

The Red Ones by Bert Redgrave

"Hi!
"Hi!...Where did you come from?"

I just got here.
Oh.

This your place?
No.
How come you're here?
The landlord, he lets me stay...
Oh.

What's that?
The red ones?
Yeah.
They're his.
What are they?
Don't know, his stash, I guess.
Tried them?
No, he said don't touch.
Oh.

Hello there handsome!

Seven Nights by Tom Wright, Jr

I
Standing amidst
 seasons convalescing
& begging why
 as the shadow of what is raised
 begins to waver.
with no pause in the breathing
 the perception of place dims,
& even in the brief presence of healing
 it builds further upon the structure of less.
II
a merging of what is yearned/attained,
theories of solace receding
 yet another day further
 from the soul's understanding;
beheld & noted
 in the eye of permission.
 within the solitary gestures
of this repetitive scene
 resides the publish need
to open a theatre,
 have a part for the longing,
but obscure is the casting;
 the reeling of monuments,
 enervation of language.
 so with its gentle voice secluded from knowledge
the body unfolds
 unto itself,
 becomes a new form of prayer.
III
brought back to childhood,
its shifting currents
& the closet's domain,
but the meaning cannot be assumed;

You tried them?
Yeah, Snake said it was ok.
Snake?
Yeah, he stopped by. He said they were awesome...
Are they?
Yeah, real waker uppers, they sorta expand you mind. Try one?
You sure it's ok?

""WAKE UPIN THERE!""

Huh. What? who's that?

""IT'S ME! LET ME IN!""

No way man, we're naked, let us get dressed.
who is it!
The landlord...
Damn!

""GETYOUR STUFF AND GET OUT NOW!""

I miss that place
Yeah, me too, this ain't a garden out here."
the beginning

fragments of night
 that propagate loss
stretch across the uneven waters
 of how this departure will be remembered,
when what is familiar changes
 & the tide declining the fall.
straining beyond still lakes of glass
 the cadence of primitive contact,
 songs to continue a species.
but with sympathy closer to shore
 the music is no longer audible.
IV
in the disregarding of centuries
 the archetypal colony
 spires into the overcast;
imposing work houses
 licking grey from the wounds of myth,
yet seemingly unwitnessed
 for what is seen only burdens.
fractured harmonies of movement,
 that pale toll then soundless;
the dissolution of crowds,
 the slow and unspoken;
a drifting through the masquerade
 of evening's destination,
 where the unlit candle burns
 a face aging in moments.
& to ever hear that rare, mad laughter
 deep in the near imagined,
 look up for reason, cease ritual,
is to feel that child hungering
 tattered & driven,
 cold & damp,
 gathering tears from the day dream,
 long nails in the sun palm.

Armageddon How? ! or "At Times Like This Before" by Anthony Simeone

God woke up, stretched, yawned, scratched Its butt, and crawled out of bed. It was the beginning of just another morning. That wasn't what God had expected at all.

"So this is what it feels like. Another end of it all. Something should be at least a little different, shouldn't it?"

God dug under Its bed for the old box It'd shoved under there a millenia ago. The search through the mounds of accumulated dust reminded It how much time had gone by since It had last moved on. Finally, hidden behind a discarded planet, God found what It was looking for. Pulling it out from under the bed, God lifted from the box a faded pair of overalls. They reeked of sweat; God wrinkled Its nose and saw that the smell was not good.

"Need to be washed" God mumbled as It slipped into its old work clothes. "I wore these for seven days straight when I started this project." The only reason It was wearing them now was for sentiment's sake; God was like that.

Again It wished that the day was different Perhaps if It examined itself a bit closer. God checked the universe that filled Its head. The galaxies still spun around a mysterious center, as they always had, in a nice tight spiral. No comets speeding backwards, water still freezing when it got really cold and so on. All of God's really big ideas still played their eternal tug-of-war. These things God noted as It rummaged through the box, taking stock of what few possessions It had gathered since...well, since God had been around. They were, like the coveralls It now wore, leftovers from past jobs and hobbies: a favorite nebula, a handful of hand-crafted creatures God felt close to, a star or too that It took pride in...all of them reminders of universes It had made before.

"I suppose it's time to decide what is going to be the keepsake this time around. Hmmm...guess I shouldn't have expected anything spectacular to happen today, really...nothing awe-inspiring has ever occurred at times like this before...But this is the day! I always expect a bit too much pomp. God moved through Its house. As It passed through Its kitchen It picked up Its favorite mug (the one that said "Kiss the Deity" in big bubble letters on the side) and filled it with moonlight from the refrigerator. Sipping absent-mindedly, God gazed out a window into the void that was Its backyard. Not a single star winked or glimmered back from the depths. The darkness was just there, like always, all formless potential. Expectation and fear grabbed and shook God. God shivered. What would the next universe look like? The old, almost forgotten tingling promise of new ideas and a fresh start returned. The unknown called to God, begging for attention and creation. But it brought guilt as well. "I feel like shit. I can't go back though. I can't change my mind now. I picked this day to do it and I am going to stick to my plans." God forced Itself to stare into the abyss for a long while.

A long, hard look. Thoughts tumbled around his cosmic mind, trickling down to merge with the emotions that rose from his terrestrial heart. God was suddenly tempted by a foolish urge to peer down at the world in Its chest that It was about to abandon. "I shouldn't look," God tried to tell Itself, "It will only make things more difficult." It had done this countless times before; change...leaving the worn-out ideas behind except for a few knickknacks to remember them by...but now God stood firm, determined not to give into sentiment.

"Damn it!" God cursed as Its resolve crumbled "Okay, just one last look." God looked down through Its own flesh, down onto Its little green and blue heart. As every day since It had found this world within, holding all of Its hope and desire, God watched what went on there. It looked past all of the angelic synaptic impulses from Its brain that flitted to and fro, going about their duties, frantically taking mental notes. This is the last really deep look I am going to get, thought God grimly, to take in the memory of all the sights and sounds. Better make it count...just in case...for the next time.

"Oh, wow, in New York City. Somebody is beating somebody else's brains out with a bat. Fascinating. Oh, listen, someone is actually praying. What's that? Change things? That's what I am about to do, but I don't think you are going to like it very much. Peace on earth? Sorry. Wish I could change the way I feel...even if I could cease all conflict within myself, that would to make existence stagnant...utterly boring. Hey, you were made in my image, weren't you? Can you always control your feelings? Aaaaah! Hey lady! Watch out for that...bus. Oops. Well, that scientist there has almost finished mapping out all of the human genetic code. Been at it for about ten years or so. A couple more days and he'd be done. If he only knew, he'd be pissed! Heh heh heh! Huh? Another prayer? Damn, this might have been a good day for organized religion! Something about...AIDS? Well, I have a really bad case of the sniffles, mister. Can YOU control when you are going to get a cold? I didn't think so. I remember the case of the flu you called the Black Death. That was lovely, let me tell ya! Never hacked up so much gunk before. Listen, just be thankful HIV wasn't around while Sodom was in full swing. Speaking of sex, look at that! How romantic. Two teenagers, in the back seat of a car, in the rain, with the radio on. Now then's art in motion...you know what, I just found my knickknack."

God scooped up the whole scene, the car, kids, rain and all. It was finally satisfied, comfortable with the coming changes. "I'm a little behind schedule, as usual. Gotta stop getting so misty-eyed over these moves. There will always be another one, right? Time I got going." God turned, flipped the lights off in the great big house, and stepped out into the backyard, leaving his old dreams behind.

UNTIL YOU GET MY POINT!!!! by John Fasczcyk

kids in a car
kids in a *car*
kids *in* a car
kids in a car
KIDS IN A CAR



From the Pens' of Bitch & Moan:

The Virtues of Barefoot and Pregnant or Where's My Dinner, O Woman? by Bitch Manly

Make way fer this here "testicled monster"! Eat yer heartout, all you hot honeys out there. Step aside you homely, jealous house wives! I'm washing down huge chunks a' red, raw, gore-dripping meat with a whole case a beer, all while scratching my butt and grabbing my crotch While watching sports and killin' endangered species with my fully-automatic phallic symbol, I'm spitting pure testosterone into the eyes of Feminazis everywhere. I tell you that I am MAN INCARNATE, here to defend the male species from all who would dare disgrace it. I am taking time out from posing in the latest Marlboro ad to set all you WOMEN (not wymyn or wimin or whatever, but WO-MEN) straight. You have forced me to open up a can of ass whippin'! Maybe I'll call you BROADS! Or how about CHICKS!? Then there's my personal favorite: SLAVES! This is WAR, my breasted enemies! You had to go and stir up trouble, didn't ya?! Ya had to be on top (pun intended) of everything all of the time. If you had only had a little patience, men would have lightened up on you in another century or so. I will not allow men to become the oppressed of

the two sexes! So now you have forced me to brandish my long hard Rod of Reason to fend off the mooing hordes (herds?) of disgruntled feminists, led by that estrogen-oozing zealot Moan of Are! I will smite her and she will beg for more! You know she wants it! And it will come to pass that only men will wear pants! The air will thicken with the victorious smell of the burning of those silly suits for women. Bah! The very thought of the blasphemous skirt-and-blazer combination gives me the dry heaves! A bastard-spawning union if there ever was one! With the ever-faithful Slappy Stink Monkey on my back, I will lead the tribes of man to the promised land of beer and money! There ya have it men, your rallying cry ! This is your last chance to save yourselves from a future of cooking, cleaning and changing diapers. If we lose now, they'll make us wear dresses later! There is no longer any possibility of equality; the "wymyn" have made sure of that! Never let them take the MAN out of MANKIND!NOW GET OUT THERE AND SPANK'EM INTO SUBMISSION! BANZAI!

Take Your Knight In Shining Armor And Shove It!

or I am womahn hear me roar! by Moan of Arc

Bitch and Moan has always been seen as the silly ramblings on unintelligent dullards around here. No more! Since Obi Moan Kenobi is not yet back from his safari for the elusive Slappy Stink Monkey (such a "manly" thing for him to be out hunting things for sport much like he and his fellow neanderthals do with womyn), I have decided to use this as a forum to further the cause for womyn everywhere. It is time we wimmen all rise up and bring down the penis infested society those beer drinking, genital dangling, rude, obnoxious, stereotyping, dullards have thrust upon us. (Slappy Stink Monkey is the personification of all these traits. He smells, is always pleasuring himself (what else can "slap" mean to a male?) and is a primate).

Stop and look at the social conventions they have created for us! Simply the words woman and female have "man" and "male" inside them. They are linguistically referring to having man or male inside of us. This only shows their views of us as mere sexual toys for them to play withand discard like a pair of soiled undies! We should curtly inform them that the word "male" and "man" is merely a little tiny part of the words "female" and "woman" thus they are insignificant compared to us!

The postal service also known as the mail. Mail is a homophone of male and it is no accident. That big thing in the

sky? The sun? Son? Son is a male! Even God himself is sexist towards us wy-myn: in sex, the womahn is the receiver of the act. Why cannot we be the givers? Are we to lie down on our back and just take what we are given? !

Look at their architecture. Skyscrapers plunging away into the sky. Odes to their manliness. They even have the audacity to talk to their cars as if they are pheemails. Why? Because they "ride" cars. Even that cave painter who counters my argument here, Bitch Manly. We see his subtle attack on us. Bitch Manly meaning Manly Bitch meaning that those of us who speak out against their gender barrier are nothing but big manly bitches. Even if we wish to bring down the gender barrier, we need a wrecking ball. Ball? Testicles? They want us to use their phallic tools?! We shall not take it anymore, right laydees?

I leave you with the words of great womyn poet, Sylvia Plath (who was driven to suicide by having the male world thrust upon her!) "Out of the ash / I will rise with my red hair / And I eat men like air." So go out and slay this testicled, genital dangling monsters with the sword of sexual harrasment and glass ceilings! Wield it as the man wields his AK-47 in a schoolyard of little children! And if the man you strike with it didn't deserve it, who cares? The world will be a better place regardless.

BLUE IN GREEN
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STEVE-THE HOT DOG MAN
 Alien-Abductee
 Resident Greek scholar at Rutgers
 and a trained professional.

if only i'd known by sean mulroy

she was my every hunger
she was the mystery that perfected a masterpiece
she was my best friend, my princess, my salvation
she was my life raft, but i never could swim
if only i'd known

she clutched me longingly on that August night
her curls flowed over us like a whispering breeze
while she enticed me into her precious lair
my ship had already been thrashed by her song
if only i'd known

we were two lovers who never made love
you'd never understand. you couldn't.
we parted with a kiss and an "until then"
still i cry the tears of a deserted baby, but i'm still here
if only i'd known



...MIMNRUHH PRINCESS ... ARRRMNN MAKE A WISH YOU BASTARD! MIMNN...

Snap-Shot: On Poetry by Amy Popp

I've heard it's a gift to be poetic. I believe this is true. Poets are the ones who explore depths of emotions that most are unaware of. Poets are the ones who wake up the populus from their sleepy, mechanical, automatic pilot lives.

The Sperm Prince by Andrea Chrisman

Warren had been thinking about her for the past three hours and twenty-six minutes (which for a sperm was a pretty long time). He was born only hours ago, and since then had been filled with the image of his perfect bride. She was round and full of genetic information. Better yet, she was the only surviving gamete of her parent cells. Her name was Amelia, and Warren was determined to have her.

However, his three brothers had the same notions. He didn't have to worry about George--he was born with two tails and couldn't propel himself anywhere. But Bob might be a problem. He was born with two heads and twice the genetic information necessary to think. He never did seem to know which direction to swim, though, which to Warren seemed odd. Bob had been the rebel of the family for a long time. He refused to listen to instinct and swimming in the direction they were all destined to go

But Warren dreamed. His formidable challenge--his brother Rosenthal, was also dreaming of Amelia. In fact, the whole colony couldn't think of anything else. They weren't meant to. But Warren thought that he was definitely the one who would win her hand in marriage, and she would invite him into her heart.

In the meantime, Warren and Rosenthal made preparations for the time when they would be called to action. They practiced swimming upstream and wiggling their tails faster and faster. They learned to use other sperm as a means to get ahead. Warren was determined to make it to Amelia and woo her before anyone else got the key to her heart. He didn't even want the others to get to her front door, however he knew that Amelia would accept a few of his acquaintances as friends and invite them to see the work of her interior designer. But he simply had to win her heart. So this motivated him for his life, knowing that if he didn't succeed, he would surely die.

He worked along side his brother and fought hard to keep up

with Rosenthal's progress. Secretly, however, Rosenthal had been striving hard to be better than his brother (getting a membership at the local gym in addition to rigorous pool training) when Warren wasn't looking. So in truth, it was Rosenthal who grew the tougher of the two strong brothers.

George continued to try to get along with his two tails, difficult as it was; he improved himself so much that he became just as good a swimmer as his brothers, though they would never know; they paid him no mind. Bob, on the other hand, never did quite manage to get his sense of direction down. He continued to swim against the walls of the John's epididymis until the great moment of truth came.

Suddenly in a rush of motion, the blood began to warm the surroundings. Warren and his brothers sensed that the time was approaching, so they began their journey down Ureter Avenue (which for them was a new direction in the new tropical weather). It was like a river flowing them to the promised land. A bustle of excitement greeted the brothers as they made their journey. Despite the cramped quarters, everyone was in high spirits, all dreaming of the same true love: Amelia, the egg queen. It didn't occur to any of the young men that they couldn't all have her. They were motivated by a deeper drive. That drive that testosterone made possible. It was an instinct to swim to this woman, whether deadly slime pits, or hair follicles stood in the way.

They were fast approaching the end of Ureter Avenue, and looked out into the dark cool air of the bed of Herman Dunn. He was new at building the tunnel. As the sperm tried to avoid being splattered on the bedspread, and thus their death, Herman struggled trying to keep up his end of the deal. Cries of agony were heard as sperm cousins died left and right in the throws of John's premature ejaculation. Finally, Herman managed to bridge the gap between the two ends of the gate. Warren and his cohorts rushed at once to reach the other end.

The Sperm Prince continued:

Meanwhile, Amelia had also begun preparing for her journey. She was getting ready to go to the local club-the Fallopian Doowop. For some reason, on this occasion, it took her two days to reach the place, and she was feeling mighty old. As a matter of fact, she felt very close to death; she knew that if she didn't meet a man, it was curtains for her. So she kept her eyes peeled for any strangers that may have walked in looking for a good time with a girl having the genetic information befit a human.

When the sperm competitors began descending on the street that lead to the Fallopian Doowop, they noticed a complete shift in the landscape. The way was somewhat larger than Ureter Avenue. Though it was just as warm, half of the colony had died somehow. Some did not make it when the bridge was not fully closed yet and ended up sad remains on the paisley printed bedsheets. However, more died upon entrance into the new cavity. It seems that there was a noxious fluid surrounding the young sperm that was slowly eating away at their heads. Warren, feeling the burning sensation attacking his cell membrane, knew that he had to run for his life, so he swam as best he knew how, dodging this and that, stepping over other sperm, and getting hold of tattered skin cells that littered the streets. Rosenthal was no where to be found. Warren shouted out for his brother, but got no answer. He assumed him dead, or far behind. But as he looked forward, he saw his brother George in front of him, two tails and all swimming furiously towards his love. Warren gained speed from jealousy alone, stepped on his brother, and moved quickly on to reach the club.

It seemed that when maps were given out at the start of the journey, no one had mentioned the huge Uterus Park that lie in the middle of the path. Many of Warren's acquaintances had already perished on the way; this was where most of them were slaughtered. They were kidnapped, murdered, and beaten to death by unseen foes. Some simply went mad. It was pure luck that Warren had made it to the entrance of the Fallopian Doowop. Here, Warren felt himself mobbed by a rush of people and beer flowing out the door. So he put his many hours of practice to work swimming his pretty little tail through the sea of sperm heads, never losing sight of his goal.

Then he saw her. She was sitting at the bar with Tanquerey in hand and had the most beautiful cuves he had ever seen. He knew that he was of the few lucky ones that had even arrived this far. Excitement filled his head, and Warren saw the future coming to a climax. He swam faster than ever. Amelia seemed to beckon with her eyes, and got up off her bar stool. They met,

and embraced. But, here came his brother out of the corner of his eye. Warren was quick with small talk: "How do you like the club?"

"Oh, it's ah right I suppose. I'm sick of hanging out here. Let's go to my place.

Warren thought his heart would stop. "Really?" he asked, surprised

"Yeah, sure. As a matter of fact, why not ask your brother to come along, too. I would love to get to know him." She winked at Rosenthal.

"Well I'm sure that I could show you a plenty good time without my intellectually stunted brother. He has nice legs, but I assure you, not the superior genetic information I have." Said Warren rather defensively.

"I'm sure" she said sensuously in the direction of Rosenthal and his huge rippling pectoral muscles.

Though Warren was strong, his muscles didn't ripple the way Rosenthal's did. Warren finally realized what his brother had done, and founding himself jealous, felt foolish for trusting his I brother. He flung himself at Amelia in a fitful passion as did Rosenthal.

There sat Amelia with two flagella protruding from the sides of her head. She offered them both tea and biscuits as they sat in her living room. Rosenthal excused himself to "freshen up" in the bathroom. There, Rosenthal removed his "A's" hat (the Acrosomes being his favorite baseball team), and laid it on the counter just before washing his hands.

Outside, Amelia broke the news to Warren gently. "Sorry honey. You just ain't got what I'm lookin for. Maybe next time around."

Warren felt death coming to him. He was dying of a broken heart as Amelia trotted her way up the steps to her bedroom to meet Rosenthal. Warren felt a fade to black just as his brother was fully accepted into the nuptial bed. They consummated a beautiful merger as Warren disintegrated, his flagella falling limply to the floor of the living room's perimeter. Then, it disintegrated as well, leaving only a memory of the 601,944,887 sperm that didn't make it out of the battle for love.

Amelia had no regrets using Rosenthal just for his looks and his superior chromosomes. She had all the genetic information she needed, and after all, there would be more fish for the sea.

Herman began producing more sperm just as he began to zip up his pants the next morning. He had to be at work in an hour and left his lady friend lying in bed to wake up alone.

Untitled by Cory Smith

I was doing 70 down highway 476, 10 miles over what my mother told me to do. She passed away years ago, and I was late for my job at the steel mill so I was doin' seventy in my ford bronco. It was a beautiful day, and beethoven's fifth roared on my 32 inch speakers in the back seat. Jesus smiled benevolently at me from the dashboard, as I risked the pigs wraths and sent silent prayers that I would 'ave my job when I arrived. Lulu 'ad been over last night and I woke late to her blissful snore over the bleeping of my alarm. I was late for the forth time this week, not a good sign considering the "downsizing" as my boss called it. So ah topped the rise and there was a heart rending thump an a thud. I screeched to a halt, mutterin' "oh, sheet. Oh fuckin' sheet, what now?" and got outa my truck. The first thing I saw was the

halo sticking out from under front left steel belted radial. Then I slowly registered the wings sticking out from underneath the chassis, and the white robes with the incriminating treads across them. I didn't see any blood, but it was pretty likely that it wasn't alive. "Aw shit. Well, wadda ya know, an angel in berkeley's rise. On route 476 no less. And preacher Bob was calling this the devil's country." I looked about but at 6:45 a.m. not a car in sight. I sighed shook myself and went about dragging the body off the road. Beautiful golden curls caught the early morning light as I turned it over in the grass. Now it occurred to me, if this was a real live, rather dead angel here; I was in a position to answer a lot of questions about sex of fore said beings and the like. I was about to divest the body of the robes when it also occurred to me

Untitled by Cory Smith Continued:

I wouldn't be able to leave it here, now would I? So I tossed it into the back of my truck and covered it up. As I walked around to my door, getting later every minute I stooped down and picked up the halo. As I got in I tossed the halo under my seat and looked up into the gaze of the plaster Jesus on my

dashboard. I couldn't avoid the gaze so I tossed it under the seat as well. Mama didn't raise no fool, what ever the state, an angel was worth a fortune. Besides what could I do? It was stupid enough to try to cross I-76 at 6:44 a.m. in the morning and I was late.



kiss me by amy sciarretto

Sweet blood surrendered
cut me deep. the incision irreparable
with sutures or stitches or staples
suck the thick, wet, sweet blood
with your joules and lips and tongue and teeth and muscle.
those throat muscles.
SWALLOW me...suck the wound,
swallow the infection in my blood.
swallow yourself.
feast on my blood like a puma,
ravenous, panting after the first kill in days.
tastes good, doesn't it?
better when my blood is taken
rather than given.
sweet blood surrendered.
your turn to ingest the wound
that i cannot afford.
not hospitalization.
it costs too much for me to bleed
it cost me my life;
it will never cost you yours.

LEAD STORIES

* Clarence Mulloy, weary of doctors who don't keep their appointments, filed a lawsuit in November against one of them, Dr. Lawrence Amato of Round Lake Beach, Ill., and won \$10 plus court costs. Mulloy claimed that Dr. Amato once canceled merely because his nurse was away and he didn't want to have to hook Mulloy up to a heart monitor all by himself.

* In December, McDonald's opened restaurants in its 100th country, Belarus, amid about 4,000 eager customers and 500 protestors, and a few days later, in its 101st, Tahiti. According to New York Times columnist Thomas Friedman, no two

countries with McDonald's restaurants have ever gone to war against each other--because, as Friedman theorizes, countries prosperous enough to support a McDonald's are surely stable enough to resist most provocations.

* Texas A&M student Jonathan Culpepper and his fraternity Kappa Alpha were indicted in College Station, Tx. in December on a criminal hazing charge because of a severe "wedgie." The grandjury found that fraternity members lifted a candidate, unnamed in news reports, off his feet by the waistband of his briefs, causing the man to require the surgical removal of a testicle.

Taking out the Trash Ziggy Nix

The key slid easily into the lock, a swift jerk on the key unlocked the door. A twist of the knob and a hard push against the door opened the apartment. The pleasant sound of the lock clicking filled the room, keeping the world out of the apartment. The only light in the room was let in by the closed vertical blinds

covering the sliding door, shafts of light chopped the floor into twenty sections. Shoes, jeans, socks, shirt, and underwear pulled off and thrown into a rowing pile of dirty clothes on the floor. Knees bent to the carpet, kneeling towards the sliding glass door, the whip came easily into the hand.

The preacher yelled of fire and brimstone for those who did not repent their sins. Crack.

The office workers gathered around the cooler giggled. Crack.

The searching eyes of the cool crowd in school. Crack.

The angry ones walking the street. Crack.

The failing of relationships. Crack.

The failing of the world. Crack

Dying for all their sins. Crack

Dying for all their sins. Crack. I

The mind cleared of the daily trash of life.

everybody means nothing to anybody somewhere by Bruce Kramer

In a nonsense of people who mean nothing to no one,
everybody, who is elsewhere,
is thinking everyone thinks everything of not just
anyone or everybody
or that they're somebody who means
something to someone...any one somewhere anywhere out there
without realizing how selfless his self concerned selfishness felt
to someone somewhere who somewhat knows the the meaning
of the feeling caring and sharing,
When instead of feeling,
everybody's, who is elsewhere, actions supported someone
somewhere
when he said every body must be dead.
Everybody's lack of imagination
led to moral stagnation and brain fermentation
day by day feeding to the decay of everybody's mind.

Moral: Do not be everybody. Be someone somewhere who
somewhat knows the
meaning of the feeling caring and sharing. Look at what you want
to do when
you don't use what you have and wonder what do you do when
you do want to do
something with what you DO have.

Cat by Gregory Pardlo

I.
She loved that cat so
much she'd lock
it in the next room when
ever her fat son began
to wheeze. Don't worry
Baby, she'd say. I'll
get that draft fixed
and she'd fidget with the
sliding glass window over
looking Riverfront Prison, the
river, the Philadelphia sky
line reminiscent of
the storied Ms. Gloria
told about her husband
the steel-worker.
Built the top floors of all those buildings.
Only job you could get back then
cause wouldn't none of they folk go up that high.

II.
And she'd think about how
man who used all nine
would climb through the sky
like a big black cat.
(And chile that man could dance,
bless his heart). She'd smile.
And she'd turn in gentle
temerity looking over her
son at the futile paw claw

ing caught in the nap of the carpet
like a comb in the morning
hair from under the bedroom
door from wherein that cat
would lie on her
son's chest in bed, would climb
into his mouth, down
his throat and nestle among
the wet fur of cilia
within sharing dreams
of a superhero who
could melt into the night.

III.
Seventeenth floor, yes and the city
won't fix the drafty glass door, she'd
tell the doctor at the clinic. If
she had tools she'd fix it herself, of
course. But maybe he's aller
gic to something at daycare, she'd
suggest. And the doctor wants to listen
at his back now, deep breaths
and she recalls with each slow
draw of air his laughter at his own
voice after sucking from the balloon
she'd untied the string from for him
at is escaped through
his surprised fingers
into the corners of the room.
And catching herself smiling,
she'd known to keep in mind
the times she'd find him sitting
up in bed stretching the slack
cat from his tatted bedshirt like pizza
cheese.

IV.
One morning her fat son,
with the cat in his lap, say
on the balcony - legs dang
ling over the ledge like a seventeen
story swing set overlooking the sandlot
directly below, face framed
between the steel bars
he held echoing in either fist
and imagining the clouds as hot
air balloons inhaling like great
big cotton candy machines
so close you c'd sniff
at 'em, listening to the music
from Ms. Gloria's nest
door, wondering how to
make him
come back and save
them all.



...MMM! MOONLIGHTING... ARRR! POOR BASTARD GOT TO EAT! MMM!

They Veiled Their Faces by Susan Muaddi

Did they look down, when the truth shone,
Like a blazing Apollo above their heads?

Did they scorn you when you craved
A sympathetic voice beside your bed?

Your blood races through the tunnels
Of my veins, traveling along to reach
The cord they could never cut between us.
And when your own blood pooled around your body,
Like lakes of infection and sadness,
And your eyes closed on all your dreams and ambitions,
I bathed my mind in it.

Now I have also been stained,
Seeing you in the pain of another Us lowered head,
Your reflection in the slipping tear of Cassandra.

Tales of Sri Lanka 2045. by Matthew W. Weatherbee

The year is 2045. I have been teaching Biochemistry and conducting research on neurological stimulation, cause and effect of virtual reality and a populace drug manufactured by ARA Foods, Inc. It is an interesting field, teaching. I have never followed the rules and due to Internet and Cable classrooms much of my time can be spent on Bit Pirating and Subculture. Unlike the classrooms of 2007 where teachers had one on one relationships with their classes of about 30 students, we are in the big leagues with student attendance on two planets and fourteen satellites. One class I taught had 387,000 attendance, it beat a major Cable production "Three's Company", a goofy sitcom of three men flirting and bickering with each other, while trying to put one over on the landlord.

Despite my occupational pursuit, I have kept up with a passe school of thought called literature. It was outlawed in 2002 by an ultra sensitive senator from PA. She felt that since so many ideas were represented in this school of thought, she would narrow confusion through censorship. The first thing she did was eliminate a word from Huckleberry Malcolm Jamal Finn, if I remember correctly. It was many years ago. I remember little protest when this happened and crazier still when the senator began introducing revisionist publications no one even knew. I think it had to do with the Water Treatment Act of 1999.

About six years ago a friend of mine, the Honorable Dr. Bernstein, an ancient learned scholar and judge, sent me some coded E-mail. It took about three months to translate, but you can never be too careful on the Internet. She had mentioned that a book from the late 19th century had been found in an archeological dig at Love Canal. It was perfectly preserved. The leader of the dig was an old comrade of mine from the 2017 Peoples Riot. He knew what he had found and contacted Judge Bernstein immediately. She bought it, I think, for 70,000 Yen. She was trying to organize a lecture on the Internet through IM's, but ran into legal problems like: she got caught.

That is when she contacted me. She had made a deposit in the Bank of Pangea for 30,000 Yen in my name and requested that I, a former student of hers, would conduct an Internet lecture.

There was no way I was going to try, for you were doomed to get caught unless you coded it. Lecture in code is just too complicated, half your students spend all their time decoding and you never really know who is listening.

Anyway I thought of another idea, which was to conduct a lecture in an auditorium in Sri Lanka. It was an old stripper joint, and no one would even dream that a lecture on literature would be held there. So I rented it out for three years and bailed Dr. Bernstein out with what was left in the account. I picked her up at the Hilton Penitentiary/Observatory at three p.m. Naturally I was late and arrived in time to save a prison guard from a detailed lecture of how Howard Stern was a brilliant "magical realist", probably the Water Treatment Act of 1999.

"Judge Bernstein", I interrupted.

"Yes, yes how are you?", she replied.

"How are you. I do believe it was you that was doing hard time."

"Well...It's not so bad...I was wondering if you had made the necessary arrangements for an Internet lecture..."

It was then that I rushed her into the hovercraft, the last thing I wanted was a broadcast of plans that landed her in the slammer in the first place. Our conversation continued...

"So I assume that you have the 'book', you do don't you!", she inquired.

"Yes, I got the 'book'. Listen, about the lecture, I...", I began.

"Wait, you mean to tell me that the monies that I sent you were not used for the..."

"If you would let me finish I can tell you all about it."

I rambled on about the legality of an Internet lecture and convinced her thoroughly that it was not the way to go. I informed her of how the account was used, she showed markedly that she was pleased. In fact she thought it was a marvelous idea. A literature symposium for all and being in Shri Lanka it would be a great vacation.

Shri Lanka was not just a shot in the dark, it was like the antithesis of 20th century Singapore. The Parliament of that state had refused to comply with Global State Ideal Behavior

Tales of Sri Lanka Continued:

Statute Committee. They felt that Krishna would have opposed it, so did they. I had traveled there many times to distance myself from the mid 21st century ideal of civility. It is a seedy place at times with whores, drugs, and guns. Seedy for sure, but they cater to tourists. It possessed an air of richness. It's smells stifling, there was poverty, corruption and gas was pretty cheap, in fact it was the only place where the internal combustion engine was still used. They were sanctioned heavily by the GSIBSC, but their sovereignty was never violated, I'll give the GSIBSC that much. It had all the elements that 20th century Postmodernism literature tried so very hard to creatively convey. So this was the country for the first seminar on literature to be held in almost **40 years**.

We traveled to a hotel in Amsterdam to meet with Bahnu Vardinathan, the hall owner and Tattooed Paul, my associate who I hired to look after the book. We all ate a marvelous dinner, secured all business and during coffee and dessert we all peered at the 'book'. Bahnu was disinterested, he was more involved with the complimentary hashish than with a great relic such as the 'book'. But Judge Bernstein, Tattooed Paul and I spent the rest of the evening taking turns letting the words silently cascade through our lips, as if we were consuming a fine wine or an illicit cigar. We each waited for our turn, watching transfixed upon the reader, as though they were Venus, their mouths moved and occasionally they glanced up to revel in the fact that it was theirs for the moment. It became a sort of dance to articulate the words silently with gestures and facial expression. The evening continued on in laughter, joy and drunkenness. We were the possessors of an artifact as holy as the Buchanan Version of the Electronic Bible and as illegal as murder, we were in rhapsody.

We set out the next day to see Bahnu off at the airport. He was to cater for a huge festival, have the place cleaned up and order all the accouterments of a lecture. He was a kind and efficient man, very suspicious of authority and that is why we trusted him. Later we ended up at the Fax 'em Coffee House and contacted all of our colleagues of subculture, about three hundred guests were expected.

"You are cordially invited to the festival "SAVANT". You have been elected from a select group and attendance would be in your very interest. A festival that reads delight. Thank you and welcomes will be to us."

All we had to do was wait. We stayed in Amsterdam because Shri Lanka was a little too harsh for Judge Bernstein at her age. A week passed, we sent Tattooed Paul ahead to make sure everything was in order. He was very anxious, Shri Lanka was his favorite place on Earth. The evening before my flight, I wanted to run over the plans for the lecture with the Judge. Get her opinions on the whole deal.

I asked her, "Should we discuss the rhetorical writings and the conventions of the 19th century?"

She replied, "I think we should just stick to Postmodernism of the 20th century to keep a frame of mind. I mean we could talk about early Greek Tragedies if we wanted to, but since the lecture was concocted because of the 'book' we should limit our scope...to create an intensity".

I felt that this was feasible, but felt that we should at least

include Sarah Orne Jewette.

She asked, "Why is that?"

"I don't know... I thought it was an interesting story, I think. Don't you think it would sum up 19th century literature?"

"Yea, maybe, but we don't have a copy to read."

"True." I said holding the 'book', the only book. "This is going to be more difficult than I thought."

"Yes, it is going to be a little hard to conduct a lecture without any media."

"Well, I have a good idea. We'll just talk about what literature means to us. I'm sure everyone is going to freak once they learn I that we HAVE a book to read. They wouldn't care if we sang old Bob Denver songs. We'll talk about the power of rhetoric writing and gender differences in writing styles. About women's roll in literature in the 19th century, writing about oppression. We'll discuss Mark Twain just to be subversive."

"Ginsberg, Cummings and Alcott as well."

"We can just say how worlds opened up as we gained perspectives from others creativity. How reading questions your reality and forces you to consider ideas that otherwise you would have been ignorant of."

"Yes!"

"Well just bullshit 'em for an hour or so, Ha ha ha ha."

The next day I was off with butterflies in my stomach, not that I was nervous, just excited. It wasn't as though I had anything to worry about, we were in a safe haven, Shri Lanka. It wasn't any kind of formal lecture, simply because it was subculture. Subculture was never formal. Excitement and to be honest grief, that was why I had butterflies. This whole 'book' thing had taken me back to the time when literature was censored and the book closed forever. I remember how ignorant I thought the world would be when they did that, but I was wrong. The world didn't get more ignorant, because they were teaching Abstract Calculus in the 6th grade, it just became devoid of a certain life. Of course we still had fine art for the eye to interpret, but there is something about the creative use of language. The way humans convey ideas through words. Yes, it was grief. Grief that my son would never feel the anger from All Quiet on the Western Front, that he would never be able to speculate for himself what Malcolm Y would have done for the world or walk the dream that Alice walked without someone else's ideas before his. That's what was most special about literature, the mind's eye made a picture that was personal. I'm sure that King Arthur looks much different to me than what Tattooed Paul thought, because we are individuals. I guess that is why so many years ago they felt it was unethical to continue this school of thought.

I could see the smog of Shri Lanka through my portal window and soon it would be time to land. I moved to the aisle seat to call the steward for one last drink. Across the aisle from me sat a wide eyed boy with mongoloid features. He was staring at me as I shuffled closer; as I returned his stare, he smiled. He smiled a most pleasant smile and his eyes were so, so deep. I thought to myself the analogy of this boy and a society without literature, I was inspired. I produced the 'book' to his delight, gave him an impish look which he returned and proceeded, "I Am Waiting for my case to come up...and I am waiting..."

*A poem by Lawrence Ferlinghetti, "I Am Waiting"

Untitled by John faszczyk

Never realizing my primitive desires, I had recently discovered that a very large part of my existence is destined to rape and pillage. The thoughts of other people, as they are shared with me (often voluntarily) bring me to tears, or hurt my face with wide smiles of ecstasy and jovial euphoria, or sometimes intimidate me and make me feel like a complete social outcast. Nonetheless, there is an irresistible, dangerous, and consistent urge, on my part, to know what others are feeling, thinking, and doing. And so I rape and pillage as I have said before. I utilize words of inquiry and inspire a forced entry into their mind. And the worst part of all is that some are still virgins with dark hallways of thought, that have never been exposed to the light of discussion over a cup of tea, or coffee, or what have you!

...And there was the time when everything was constantly in motion. I couldn't stop to catch my breath. The thought of being alone for more than a pico-second terrified the living hell out of me. Moving from person to person, from friend to friend, from kiss to kiss.

The tall blond was in my room. His head now shaved bare. This was when we got along famously. I warned of what was about to occur because I knew he would find it upsetting. I remembered being introduced to him as a "staight-edge cat" by one of my friends. I felt a strange sensation of anxiety and guilt

and finally great confusion.

A kncok at the window reverberated throughout the room. Jimmy was here and with desire. A large bag of mushrooms had left my hand and entered his. So simple like a pharmaceutical exchange. The transaction transpired through my window. He placed an envelope containing two-hundred dollars in my hand and I couldn't help but stare at his face. As he grasped the bag his eyes shined and for a moment I thought he was glowing. I looked at the bag in his hand and the money in mine and felt a sense of relief, but it quickly turned to nausea.

The rotten stems and grotesque heads which gave off the foulest of odors and most putrid flavor were going to make Jimmy's Saturday night. I, on the other hand, had to get the money to its rightful owner and contemplate why the fuck I ever agreed to do this in the first place. It made two friends happy. One got more money than most teens make in a week, and the other, well the other had a weekend a bit more colorful than the usual. Me, I was a middleman. No share of drugs or money for me. Neither even interested me. So why? I don't know. There are no reasons, no excuses, nothing I could say to justify anything. But perhaps Bob Dylan put it best when he said,

"...but I was so much older than,
I'm younger than that now!"



(...HEH HEH HEH... COLORS... BIZARRE THOUGHT PATTERNS... HEH HEH HEH... REVELATION... HEH HEH HEH... COLORS...)